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NEWSPAPER

20th July, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

29th WEEK



USA SANCTIONS ON IRAN

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF DEVELOPED AND DEVELOPING COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS.



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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

20th JULY, 2017

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Target Tehran

The Trump administration's new sanctions on Iran threaten stability in West Asia

The U.S. administration's decision to slap sanctions on 18 Iranian individuals and entities on Tuesday, only a day after it certified to Congress that Tehran was compliant with the conditions of the nuclear deal, sums up its strategic resolve in taking on the Islamic Republic and the tactical dilemma it faces while doing so. It is no secret that President Donald Trump has been critical of the Iran nuclear deal, which ended the international sanctions on Tehran in return for curbing its nuclear programme. During the campaign, Mr. Trump had vowed to either kill or renegotiate the agreement. But as President, his options are limited with Iran remaining compliant with the terms of the agreement. More important, it is not a bilateral pact. The nuclear deal was reached among seven entities, including the U.S., Russia, Germany and Iran. Any unilateral move to withdraw from the agreement would hurt American interests as European countries are keen on expanding economic ties with Iran. This explains why a reluctant Mr. Trump has re-certified the deal twice since his inauguration in January. But on both occasions, he slapped additional sanctions on Iran over its ballistic missile programme and "support for terrorism", signalling that the Obama-era détente with Tehran was over. Administration officials are now saying Iran may be compliant with the terms but it is "unquestionably in default of the spirit" of the agreement.

This is an overstretched argument, given that all international monitors say Iran remains committed to the deal. The logical next step of the nuclear agreement should have been an overall improvement in relations between the West and Tehran. Barack Obama had set the stage for such a policy overhaul and Iranian President Hassan Rouhani had responded to it, but Mr. Trump, in six months, has taken Washington's Iran policy back to Republican neoconservatism. Besides sanctions, Mr. Trump has also endorsed the Saudi-led Sunni bloc's attempts to isolate Iran. His policy priorities are now clear. The administration will align with Saudi Arabia and Israel, continue to target Iran through sanctions and even try to undermine the nuclear deal in



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IMPORTANT QUESTIONS?

ESSAY/ MAINS / GD / INTERVIEWS

In view of more and more isolation of Iran by USA, critically examine it's implications on the geo-politics of West Asia?

IRAN NUCLEAR DEAL ... WHAT WAS IT ABOUT?

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TALKS WERE BETWEEN

6 ADVANCED NATIONS
+
IRAN

ALSO KNOWN AS

P5 + 1
+
IRAN





E 3 + 3

EUROPEAN UNION



GERMANY
FRANCE
UK

+

USA
RUSSIA
CHINA



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BRIEF PERSPECTIVE

PAST HISTORY

- *Advanced nation's contention was that Iran is building nuclear weapons.*
- *Hence, international sanctions were imposed since 2006.*
- *But, Iran was insisting that its nuclear activities are entirely peaceful.*
- *On and off talks for 12 years, culminated with an agreement.*

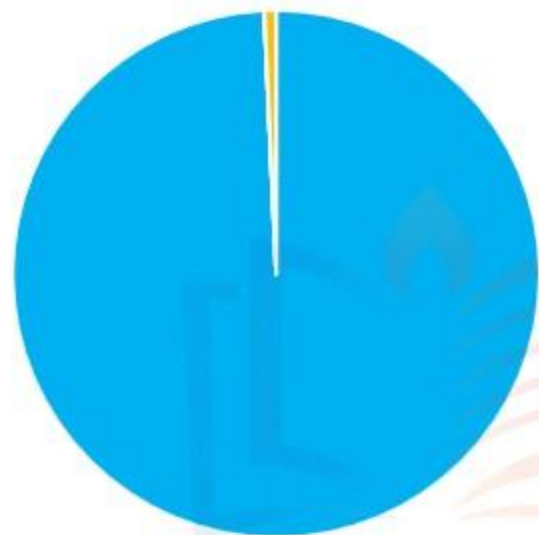
SALIENT POINTS

- Iran agreed to get rid of **98% of its stockpile of enriched uranium**.
- Centrifuges, which are needed to enrich uranium will be reduced from **19,000 to 6,000**.
- Enrichment will be **stopped at underground Fordow facility**.
- **Strict inspection by IAEA**.
- **UN arms embargo** will remain in place for **5 years**.
- **Embargo on missiles** will be there for **8 years**.



ENRICHED URANIUM

What do you understand?



Natural uranium
>99.2% U-238
0.72% U-235



Low-enriched uranium
(reactor grade)
3-5% U-235



Highly enriched uranium
(weapons grade)
90% U-235





NEWS REPORT

DONALD TRUMP AND IRAN



- 1 Donald Trump has been critical of the Iran nuclear deal. During the campaign, Mr. Trump had vowed to either kill or renegotiate the agreement.
- 2 It is not a bilateral pact.
- 3 It was reached by six nations with Iran.
- 4 As per the news reports, Iran is compliant with the terms and conditions.

The United States of America slapped additional sanctions on Iran over its ballistic missile programme and support for terrorism in recent times.



ISOLATION OF IRAN BY USA ... DOES IT GIVE CONCRETE RESULTS?

- 1** As Iran is believed to be complying with the terms of the civil nuclear deal, further sanctions may not be acceptable to the European countries, who are keen to establish business relations with Iran, because of slowdown in Europe.
- 2** As Iran is complying with the nuclear deal, the world community will question the USA, with regard to further sanctions.
- 3** The USA is trying to isolate Iran by siding with Saudi Arabia and this will further complicate the matters in West Asia.





ISOLATION OF IRAN BY USA ... DOES IT GIVE CONCRETE RESULTS?

- 4 Iran's geopolitical clout is increasing, because of continued unrest/ civil wars and Iran's presence in countries like Yemen, Syria as well as Iraq.
- 5 To stabilise Iraq, the U.S. needs Iran's help, as in Iraq, the Shia militias are supported by Iran to fight Islamic State.
- 6 Syria also requires Iran's participation and cooperation, which is essential to restore peace, because Syrian government is fully backed by Iran.
- 7 The presence of Iran is very much there in Yemen, as it supports Houthi rebels.

The USA should reciprocate Iran's compliance with the nuclear deal, not punish it through additional sanctions. It should also act as a mediator between Saudi Arabia and Iran, instead of taking sides in a destabilising cold war in West Asia.

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